

widows in official records just to avail Rs 300 per month, thereby milking the Government ("Ghosts in the Darkness", August 31). Not only is the sanctity of the Vidhwa Pension Yojana degraded, but its very purpose is defeated by those involved in this racket. It's not difficult to understand that a fraud of this magnitude could not have flourished without the connivance of the officials concerned. It is the taxpayers' money that has gone into the wrong hands.

PREM K. MENON, *Mumbai*

Slum Capital

In a bid to expand their votebank, successive governments in Maharashtra have been extending cut-off dates for regularisation of slums, thus encouraging migrants and other people to grab public land for creating new slums ("Slumthing Special", August 31). In the process, politicians and real estate developers are getting their dreams realised, but a slum-free Mumbai will continue to remain a mirage for Mumbaikars.

KAUSHAL KISHORE,
Indore

The time has arrived for the formation of a top-level all-party committee chaired by the chief minister and comprising senior leaders of major political parties. It should draft a

long-term slum rehabilitation plan with a time-bound approach. Once consensus is reached on the rehabilitation plan, it should hand over the project to the implementing agencies, with the committee monitoring the progress of the plan.
BHASKAR BHATTACHARYA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Tomorrow's Truth

I congratulate INDIA TODAY in its projection of Indianness ("India

SIPRA DAS



Despite her dictatorial tendencies and a bloated ego comparable to Jayalalithaa, Mayawati and Brinda Karat, Mamata Banerjee is an inspiring leader who can motivate people.

S. LAKSHMI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Tomorrow", August 24). However, to ensure peace and stability, we need to be militarily powerful. Our military capability to thwart Chinese nuclear missile attacks on targets of their choice remains near zero. We need to be capable of striking any Chinese target of our cho-

ice with our nuclear missiles. Then we can talk of peace and dream of the India of tomorrow.
AIR CMDE V.V. NAIR VM,
Manipal

Brothers at War

It must be to Mukesh Ambani's credit that we now have such large quantities of gas available, which otherwise would have been imported at a high cost ("On the Warpath", August 17). Hence, nothing should be

The Indira Offensive

Sitting dead in the centre of the same imperial ballroom where she had welcomed the late Pakistani premier Zulfikar Ali Bhutto seven years ago to sign the historic Simla Agreement, Mrs Indira Gandhi was being decidedly imperious last week. Addressing the press at the apex of her two-day tour of Himachal Pradesh, she was letting off some long-accumulated steam. Sparks flew as her shrill voice echoed round the hall—and her tone was reminiscent of some departed Vicereine's, bent upon silencing a group of galling guests. "Of course," she declared, at the end of her long political tirade, "nobody takes the Indian press seriously.

More and more people read foreign papers, and listen to the BBC, for accurate information. Wherever I go the press maligns me. My meetings are never publicised." *by Sunil Sethi*

and Prabhu Chawla



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